

Sierra Shell

sierrashell.com

sierra.shell@sas.com
(828) 230-8842

EDUCATION

UCL (University College London)

MPA, Digital Technology
& Public Policy

UNC Chapel Hill

BA, Public Policy
Minors: Education,
Mandarin Chinese

AWARDS

US Patent 12450144

Model Card System

Issued Oct 21, 2025

A "nutrition label" for AI models with
proprietary metrics measuring health
and bias

CERTIFICATIONS

Center for Humane Technology

Foundations of Humane Tech

SKILLS

- AI governance & standards
- Regulatory frameworks (NIST AI RMF, EU AI Act)
- Stakeholder engagement & interviewing
- Research & user testing
- Workshop design & facilitation
- Qualitative research, synthesis & publication
- Design & prototyping
- Solving problems within inflexible systems
- Condensing & communicating complexity

Objective

Accelerate responsible AI adoption by helping customers operationalize governance and manage risk, while cementing SAS's reputation as the expert partner organizations rely on to integrate AI they can trust and scale.

[View full application experience at sierrashell.com](#)

AI Governance and Design Experience

SAS Institute, Inc. | Cary, NC

UX Designer, Trustworthy AI | 2022–Present

- Contributed design and strategy to SAS AI Navigator, the company's primary AI governance offering
- Led design of the NIST AI RMF-based Trustworthy AI Life Cycle Workflow
- Invented a patented Model Card operationalizing AI transparency — presented before the US Congress
- Generated, facilitated, and synthesized 50+ interviews, 3 focus groups, and 9 workshops over 10 years at SAS, most recently with 3 customers interested in SAS's AI governance products

BSI (British Standards Institution) | London, UK

Research Associate on AI Standards | 2022

- Conducted and synthesized 29 interviews with policymakers, executives, and other stakeholder groups for the UK's national standards body
- Investigated organizational barriers to adoption of AI standards and other governance mechanisms across industries
- Designed and facilitated 9 workshops, including a session engaging with regulators, business leaders, and experts to forecast and refine organizational AI risks
- Promoted evidence-based strategies within BSI's technical standards committee, shaping dialog on accelerating AI standards adoption

UCL | London, UK

Master of Digital Technology & Policy | 2021–2022

- Authored a 22-page report for private sector AI adopters outlining explainability strategies, their strengths, limitations, and metrics
- Studied international AI policy: EU risk-based regulation, US EOs and OSTP mandates, & NIST Risk Management Framework
- Completed courses including risk management, evidence assessment, and technical literacy within the digital space

Additional Experience

SAS Institute, Inc. | Cary, NC

UX Designer, SAS Graph & Visual Analytics | 2015–2021

- Developed user journey maps, identifying pain points and opportunities within an organization's processes and product use
- Presented at multiple speaking engagements, including international SAS User Group conferences
- Led design for SAS Visual Analytics Web Viewer and VA Microsoft Office Add-in, supporting 4.5M+ users
- Created and facilitated SAS's ethical design program, generating and prioritizing over 60 ideas to inform humane design guidelines

Publications

- Sierra Shell. "The Human Touch(point): Recommendations for Thoughtful AI Feature Design." Visible Language, Issue 59 (2025)
- BSI. "Looking Ahead: The Role of Standards in the Future of AI Governance." (2022)
- Sierra Shell et al. "Toward a General Animation Transition Framework." IEEE InfoVis Annual Conference (2017)
- Coyle et al. "Data Can Be Beautiful: Crafting a Compelling Story with SAS VA." SAS Global Forum (2017)